pre-Islamic Magian outlook in the face of the twentieth century. It is obvious that Islam, which claims to weld all the various communities of the world into one single community, cannot reconcile itself to a movement which threatens its present solidarity and holds the promise of further rifts in human society.

Of the two forms which the modern revival of pre-Islamic Magianism has assumed, Bahaism appears to me to be far more honest than Qadianism, for the former openly departs from Islam, whereas the latter apparently retains some of the more important externals of Islam with an inwardness wholly inimical to the spirit and aspirations of Islam. Its idea of a jealous God with an inexhaustible store of earthquakes and plagues for its opponents; its conception of the prophet as a soothsayer; its idea of the continuity of the spirit of the Messiah, are so absolutely Jewish that the movement can easily be regarded as a return to early Judasim. The idea of the continuity of the spirit of the Messiah belongs more to Jewish mysticism than to positive Judaism. Professor Buber, who has given an account of the movement initiated by the Polish messiah Baalshem, tells us that ‘it was thought that the spirit of the Messiah descended upon the earth through the prophets and even through a long line of holy men stretching into the present time – the Zaddiks (Sadiqs)’. Heretical movements in Muslim Iran under the pressure of pre-Islamic Magian ideas invented the words ‘buruz’, ‘hulul’, ‘zill’, to cover this idea of a perpetual reincarnation. It was necessary to invent new expressions for a Magian idea in order to make it less shocking to Muslim conscience. Even the phrase ‘promised Messiah’ is not a product of Muslim religious consciousness. It is a bastard expression and has its origin in the pre-Islamic Magian outlook.

We do not find it in early Islamic religious and historical literature. This remarkable fact is revealed by Professor Wensinck’s *Concordance of the Traditions of the Holy Prophet*, which covers no less than eleven collections of the traditions and three of the earliest historical documents of Islam. One can very well understand the reasons why early Muslims never used this expression. The expression did not appeal to them probably because they thought that it implied a false conception of the historical process. The